

Aurelia Grand Hotel Group

Brand Standards and Guest Experience Manual

Communication tone, service philosophy, ownership standards, and quality signals

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Purpose and usage

This controlled document defines operational standards for hotel teams. It is intended to support consistent decisions, clear accountability, accurate record keeping, and high-quality service recovery across Aurelia properties. Teams must apply local legal requirements when those requirements are stricter than this standard.

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1. Brand Promise and Service Philosophy

Aurelia properties aim to deliver calm, precise, and personal hospitality. The brand promise is not luxury through excess; it is confidence through care, speed, and attention to detail. Guests should feel that the hotel knows what matters and owns what goes wrong.

Standard	Meaning in practice
Calm	Staff respond with control and empathy, especially when the guest is upset.
Precise	Details are accurate: names, dates, room numbers, promises, and follow-up times.
Personal	Responses acknowledge the specific guest and situation rather than relying on generic phrasing.
Accountable	The hotel coordinates internally; the guest does not manage departments.

Brand behaviors

- Use the guest's name where natural.
- Name the specific issue before explaining next steps.
- Make one clear promise at a time and keep it.
- Do not over-apologize without action.
- Close the loop with the guest and the department owner.

2. Guest Communication Standards

Guest communication must be warm, direct, and concise. Written responses should avoid corporate language that sounds evasive. When the hotel is responsible, say so plainly and describe the corrective action at the right level of detail.

Situation	Tone	Example direction
Complaint verified	Accountable and specific.	Acknowledge failure, state remedy, state corrective action.
Facts unclear	Respectful and careful.	Acknowledge concern, explain review, offer proportionate goodwill if appropriate.
Claim unsupported	Polite and firm.	State records reviewed and invite

		further evidence.
Guest angry	Calm and non-defensive.	Lower emotional temperature before discussing policy.

Writing style

- Use short paragraphs.
- Avoid internal abbreviations in guest-facing messages.
- Do not quote policy sections unless necessary.
- Avoid phrases that imply doubt before evidence review.
- Use active ownership: “we reviewed,” “we corrected,” “I have asked.”

3. Experience Standards Across the Stay

Moment	Brand standard	Operational proof
Pre-arrival	Guest preferences and special requests are reviewed when available.	Profile notes and arrival report.
Arrival	Check-in is organized, welcoming, and accurate.	Room readiness and key control.
In-room	Room is clean, functional, and comfortable.	Housekeeping inspection and maintenance records.
Issue handling	Guest receives acknowledgement and ownership quickly.	Case note with response time.
Departure	Open issues are not ignored after checkout.	Post-stay follow-up where needed.

The guest experience is cumulative. A small issue may become material if staff fail to respond or if the guest must repeat the concern several times. Conversely, prompt ownership can reduce frustration even when the physical issue takes time to correct.

4. Department Ownership and Handoff

Aurelia guests should not experience the hotel as separate departments. Internal coordination must be invisible where possible. The staff member receiving the concern remains responsible for ensuring ownership is assigned, even if another department performs the correction.

- Front office owns guest communication unless another manager is assigned.
- Housekeeping owns cleanliness correction and quality review.
- Maintenance owns diagnosis, repair, and room status recommendation.
- Finance owns accurate posting of approved financial remedies.
- Property leadership owns high-risk exceptions and repeated failures.

Handoff quality

A strong handoff includes guest identity, issue summary, action taken, evidence attached, pending decision, promised update time, and owner. A weak handoff says only “guest complained” or “please check room.”

5. Quality Signals and Management Review

Managers should review quality signals that reveal patterns before they become brand problems. Complaints are one signal; repeat defects, room blocks, missed inspections, and exception remedies are also important.

Signal	Review question
Repeat room complaints	Is the room being released before root cause is resolved?
High remedy value	Are departments correcting the underlying failure?
VIP complaints	Is the property protecting key relationships with speed and specificity?
Fast-turnover failures	Are staffing or arrival pressure creating quality risk?
Delayed responses	Are case owners and handoff standards clear?

The brand standard is met when the hotel responds quickly, investigates fairly, communicates clearly, and corrects the operation. Compensation alone is not service recovery.

6. Measurement and Leadership Review

The brand is protected through measurement, not slogans. Property leaders should review guest recovery metrics alongside financial performance because unresolved quality issues eventually become revenue risk.

Metric	Target behavior
First acknowledgement time	Guests receive timely ownership.
Case closure time	Issues are resolved without unnecessary delay.
Repeat room complaints	Rooms with unresolved root causes are removed from sale.
Compensation value by department	Remedies reveal process gaps and training needs.
Guest response quality	Messages are specific, respectful, and action-oriented.

Leadership review should focus on learning and correction. A lower compensation amount is not automatically a sign of success; it may mean cases are being under-recognized. A higher amount is not automatically a failure; it may mean the team is taking accountability for verified issues.

7. Service Language Reference

Instead of	Use
We apologize for any inconvenience.	I am sorry the air-conditioning issue disrupted your rest.
That is our policy.	Here is what I can do now, and what requires manager approval.
Maintenance says it is fixed.	Engineering has completed the repair and tested the room before release.
Housekeeping cleaned the room.	A supervisor has inspected the room and corrected the bathroom presentation.

There is nothing else we can do.	I have reviewed the available options and this is the approved resolution.
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Clear language reduces frustration. The guest should understand what the hotel knows, what the hotel accepts responsibility for, and what will happen next.